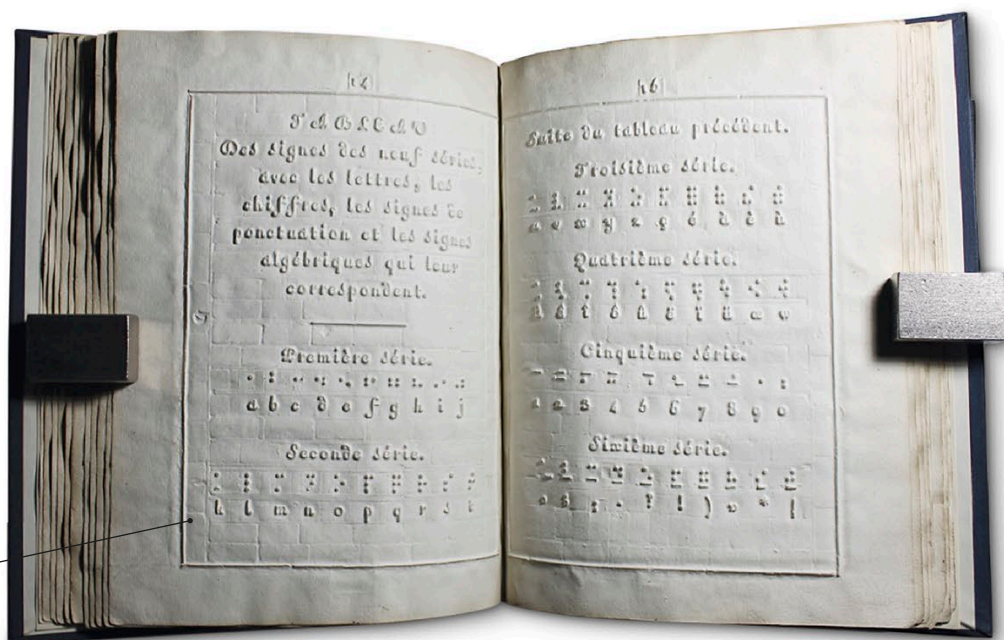


FINGERTIP READING

As a student, blind Frenchman Louis Braille encountered a way of writing messages with raised dots that was used by soldiers to communicate at night. He improved the system and published it in 1829. It is known as Braille and is still in use today.

Braille's system works with a six-dot code, used to identify the letters of the alphabet.



First Braille book, 1829

By using carbon paper, multiple copies of one document could be made.

Ink-soaked ribbon transfers marks to the paper when bit by levers carrying the type.

PUNCHING KEYS

Appropriately, the US inventor of the typewriter was an ex-newspaper editor. Christopher Sholes wanted something that would "write" faster than a pen. With the help of two fellow inventors, Carlos Glidden and Samuel Soule, he created such a machine in 1873.

Fast typists jammed keys on early keyboards such as this one, so Sholes came up with the QWERTY keyboard in 1875.

The Crandall typewriter, 1875

